

Corporate Credit Card Policy

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1. Scope

- 1.1 This Corporate Credit Card Policy (“Policy”) applies to all London School of Hygiene and Tropical Medicine (“LSHTM”) staff who hold a corporate credit card. This policy also applies to LSHTM’s subsidiary companies, including, but not limited to Chariot Innovations Limited, LSHTM Developments Limited and Sustainable Climate Impact Fund Limited.

2. Purpose and Overview

- 2.1 This policy outlines the circumstances in which it would be appropriate to issue a member of staff with a credit card, the application process and the principles to ensure the proper use of LSHTM corporate credit cards. This policy also outlines cardholder responsibilities.
- 2.2 LSHTM recognises that there are advantages to be gained by using a credit card as part of its purchasing processes.

3. Policy

- 3.1 Credit cards will only be issued to LSHTM employees who are salaried members of staff, and who are able to demonstrate that the issue of the card is required in their duties.
- 3.2 Credit cards are provided for *business use only* and purchases must comply with all associated policies and procedures, in particular LSHTM’s [Financial Regulations](#), [Expenses Policy](#) and [Procurement Policy](#). These are the policies which outline what is deemed to be appropriate business spend and it is assumed and expected that all cardholders will have read and understood these policy documents in detail. The information contained therein is not replicated within this document.



- 3.3 LSHTM's current corporate credit card provider is NatWest bank. This will be reviewed periodically to ensure value for money and an appropriate service which meets LSHTM's needs is received.
- 3.4 Card usage will be reviewed annually to ensure it is still appropriate for a card to be held.
- 3.5 Compliance with this policy is mandatory. Failure to follow this policy will result in the card being withdrawn and may result in disciplinary action. A serious breach of the policy may constitute gross misconduct and be dealt with in line with LSHTM's HR policies.
- 3.6 The Deputy Finance Director will consider each application received and determine if a card is legitimately required. The below will be carefully considered in deciding whether a card will be issued.
- 3.7 Credit cards will only be issued to LSHTM employees who are able to demonstrate that the credit card will aid in the effective and efficient exercise of their official duties. Factors that will influence the decision to issue a card to a particular employee include:
- The nature and extent of minor purchases of goods and services that may be undertaken.
 - The frequency and nature of domestic and international travel that may be undertaken in the course of official duties.
 - The need to meet the cost of official "out of pocket" expenses (including certain approved entertainment/hospitality costs).
- 3.8 The Financial Regulations state that the majority of LSHTM expenditure must be incurred through purchasing routes, primarily through raising a purchase order.
- 3.9 Restrictions on use of credit cards:
- 3.9.1 At no time should cash withdrawals be charged to an LSHTM credit card. If a cash advance is required, please follow the [Cash Advance process](#).
- 3.9.2 At no time should personal purchases be deliberately charged to a corporate card. If this has been done in error, then repayment should be made within 10 working days.
- 3.9.3 It is understood that some Departments have a 'Department credit card' which can be used by staff members within that Department subject to the approval of the card holder. If a staff member needs to use this card frequently, they should request their own credit card, subject to the conditions of the Credit Card Policy.
- 3.9.4 A credit limit for the card will be set at the time of issue and cardholders will be notified of their limit. The cardholder is responsible for ensuring that spend does not exceed this pre-approved limit. Attempts to purchase beyond the agreed limit will be declined.
- 3.9.5 Cardholders may request an adjustment to their card limit, which will be considered by the Deputy Finance Director, or their delegated alternate. These requests can be for a temporary or permanent change to the limit. Requests should be made to the [Credit Card Programme Administrator](#). Please note that the cardholder's line



manager must approve all requests for increased limits prior to consideration by the Deputy Finance Director.

3.9.6 Corporate Cards should be used for the following types of purchases where setting up a new supplier on Agresso is unnecessary:

- Low value / one off purchases (normally below £250) of goods or services where there is no alternative existing agreement in place for those goods or services.
- Purchase of incidental travel and subsistence during a trip on LSHTM business.

3.9.7 Corporate Credit Cards can also be used for the following types of purchases:

- Conference registrations

3.9.8 Corporate Credit Cards ***should not be used*** for the following:

- Making purchases from established suppliers
- Payment for professional services

3.9.9 The above items should be purchased in accordance with the [Procurement Policy](#). This is not an exhaustive list.

4. Procedure

- 4.1 To request a credit card, a business case must be submitted to the Finance and Procurement department using the [Credit Card Request Form](#). Approval to issue a credit card will be made by the Deputy Finance Director, or their delegated alternate. If approved, the credit card programme administrator will liaise with the applicant with respect to the completion of the NatWest Bank Cardholder Application form for the new corporate credit card account and the physical issue of the card.
- 4.2 The new card will be signed for by the card holder to acknowledge receipt of the card.
- 4.3 Finance will maintain a Register of all card holders.
- 4.4 The registered address for LSHTM and subsidiary corporate credit cards is London School of Hygiene and Tropical Medicine, Keppel Street, London, WC1E 7HT. This address should be used when asked for the 'invoice' or 'registered' address. The cardholder's own, School or Unit address may be used for the 'delivery' address. Please note that using an incorrect registered address when making a purchase, may result in the transaction being declined.

5. The Credit Card Programme Administrator's Responsibilities

5.1 The responsibility of the credit card administrator will be to:

- Receive authorised Credit Card applications and submit to NatWest bank.



- Receive newly issued Cards from NatWest and perform the appropriate administrative tasks.
- Notify the Cardholders of receipt of the Card for collection Register the employee up on the NatWest ClearSpend system.
- Have full access to the NatWest Online system for all Cardholders and liaise with NatWest on all matters regarding Card administration.
- Download LSHTM statement from NatWest on the 12th of every month.
- If required, cancel / suspend a Card when the Cardholder is leaving LSHTM, going on long term leave or secondment or delay in sending processing their statement.
- Remove Cards from users in cases of misuse or persistent non-compliance with this policy or LSHTM financial regulations. Any Cardholder whose Card has been withdrawn due to misuse or non-compliance will not be able to apply for a new Card.

5.2 When taking delivery of a card each cardholder will be provided with a 'Statement of Responsibilities' (see Appendix 1). This is to be signed by the cardholder to acknowledge their understanding of the conditions under which the corporate credit card is used. The cardholder is to retain a copy of this schedule. The original copy will be kept in the Finance department.

6. Card Management System

- 6.1 Card transactions are coded and submitted for authorisation using the [credit card form](#). Card transactions are normally available for coding within a few days of making the purchase.
- 6.2 If the project code has a specified approver, the form must be sent to them or a delegated administrator.
- 6.3 Full guidance on completing the credit card form system can be found in Service Desk guide on Moodle, and the cardholder training manuals.
- 6.4 A delegated administrator can be set up to assist cardholders by coding and submitting card transactions on their behalf. This will be subject to local arrangements and should be agreed with the local administrative team.
- 6.5 All transactions should be coded and submitted to the approver as soon as possible and within 10 working days of the statement date and approval must be before the end of the month. If cardholders require an extension, such as due to travel commitments/holiday they should contact creditcard@lshtm.ac.uk in advance to request an extension. It is expected in these cases that the reconciliation will take place within 5 working days of their return. Failure to code and submit transactions for approval within one month will be interpreted as a misuse of the corporate card facility and persistent delays in submission for approval may result in this facility being withdrawn, in line with section 9 below.



- 6.6 A weekly reminder is sent automatically by the Expenses Administrator advising of any outstanding actions.

7. Withdrawal Of Corporate Card Facility

- 7.1 Cardholders with transactions outstanding for more than one month will receive a reminder email from Finance to code and submit their transactions for approval.
- 7.2 Cardholders with transactions outstanding for more than two months will receive a second and final reminder from Finance to code and submit transactions for approval.
- 7.3 Cardholders with transactions outstanding for more than three months will have their corporate card facility suspended until the account is brought up to date.
- 7.4 Repeated failures to submit transactions for approval within the deadline will result in the facility being withdrawn altogether.
- 7.5 If a card is suspended or withdrawn then staff may reclaim business expenses through the expenses claim process.
- 7.6 Finance reserve the right to suspend or cancel cards immediately in extreme cases of misuse or where security of card details has been deliberately compromised through a failure to adhere to the processes outlined in section 6 above. In the event of a cardholder having their card suspended, they have a right to appeal against the decision to the Finance Director.

8. Statement Of Responsibilities

- 8.1 When applying for a credit card, the applicant will be provided with a 'Statement of Responsibilities' (see Appendix 1). This is to be signed by the cardholder to acknowledge their understanding of the conditions under which the corporate credit card is used. The cardholder is to retain a copy of this schedule. The original copy will be kept in the Finance department.
- 8.2 Cardholders issued with a corporate credit card are in a position of trust in regards to the use of public funds. All expenditure charged to a corporate credit card is subject to examination and approval by a delegated authoriser to ensure its appropriateness and compliance with the policy conditions.
- 8.3 Improper use of that trust will result in the card being withdrawn and render the cardholder liable to disciplinary and possible legal action;
- 8.4 Corporate credit cards are only to be used for official LSHTM purposes. Where inappropriate expenditure occurs, the value of the expenditure may be recovered from the cardholder.
- 8.5 Cardholders should ensure that when purchasing items on an externally funded project, that the items are eligible to be reclaimed.



- 8.6 The cardholder is personally responsible and accountable for the safe keeping of the card. Cards are to be kept secure and protected against improper use; In the event that a card is lost or stolen, the cardholder must report the loss immediately to card provider.
- 8.7 The Credit Card Programme Administrator is also to be advised at the earliest opportunity.
- 8.8 Any PIN that has been issued with the card must not be disclosed or carried with the card.
- 8.9 Monthly Cardholder Statements are to be reconciled within 10 days of the Statement Date. As part of the monthly submission process the cardholder is to certify that all charges shown are correct and were incurred for official purposes. Repeated failure to submit monthly statements in a timely fashion may result in the corporate credit card being cancelled
- 8.10 All transaction slips are to be retained and submitted by the cardholder when passing their monthly Cardholder Statements. A scanned copy must be attached to the NatWest account for approver viewing. The original sent to the expense's administrator for Finance record. Where no documentation is available to support a particular transaction, the cardholder will be required to provide a declaration detailing the nature of the expense and that is business related;
- 8.11 Credit limits are not to be exceeded
- 8.12 In the event of termination of employment cardholders will immediately destroy the credit card and ensure the credit card account is properly reconciled.
- 8.13 Cardholders must submit their expenditure once a month. Statement notification will be sent out on the 12th of each month. Employees must complete and upload all receipts within 10 working days and approval must be before the end of the month, detailing the relevant coding and obtain the necessary approval. If cardholders require an extension, such as due to travel commitments/holiday they should contact creditcard@lshtm.ac.uk in advance to request an extension. It is expected in these cases that the reconciliation will take place within 5 working days of their return.
- 8.14 If a cardholder leaves LSHTM:
 - 8.14.1 The credit card should be cut up and disposed of. Please notify the [Credit Card Programme Administrator](#) that this has been done as soon as possible so that the card can be cancelled on the system.
 - 8.14.2 If a cardholder is leaving LSHTM, they should avoid making purchases on their corporate card in the final weeks of their contract.
 - 8.14.3 The corporate credit card account must be brought up to date with all transactions coded and submitted for approval in good time before they leave.
 - 8.14.4 The School reserves the right to deduct from the cardholder's final pay any expenses on the credit card which have not been processed by their last day.



9. Credit Card Fraud

- 9.1 Cardholders are personally responsible and accountable for the safe keeping of their card. Cards should be kept secure and protected against improper use. In the event the card is lost or stolen, the cardholder must report the loss immediately to the card provider. Any transactions on an account which cannot be identified by the cardholder should be reported to the card provider directly. The Credit card programme administrator should also be advised at the earliest opportunity who will follow up with the bank.

10. Further Information & Help

- 10.1 Help and guidance, including access to all training materials and relevant policies can be found on the LSHTM Intranet.
- 10.2 Please email the [Credit Card Programme Administrator](#) for general enquiries on the Credit Card including:
- Temporary increases to credit limit
 - Changes to system set up (such as change of approver, or the addition of a delegate administrator)
- 10.3 Cardholders must call the NatWest Customer Services line for card related issues such as:
- Lost or stolen cards: +44 (0) 370 010 1152;
 - Declined transactions: +44 (0) 370 010 1152;
 - Reporting fraudulent transactions: +44 (0) 1268 508020 or +44 (0) 345 300 4351;
 - Reporting a compromised PIN, card details or any other potential security breach: +44 (0) 370 010 1152



Appendix 1 – Statement of Card Holder Responsibilities

I understand and agree that:

1. I have read and understood the Credit Card Policy.
2. My corporate credit card is only to be used for official business purposes and that should inappropriate expenditure occur, the value of that expenditure may be recovered from the cardholder.
3. My corporate credit card is only to be used by the person whose name appears on the card or with their express approval.
4. I am personally responsible and accountable for the safe keeping of the card.
5. In the event that my card is lost or stolen, I will report the loss immediately to card provider and the Credit Card Administrator.
6. Any PIN issued with the card must not be disclosed or carried with the card.
7. All transaction slips are to be retained and submitted when submitting the monthly Cardholder Statement to my authorised signatory. Where no documentation is available to support a particular transaction, I will provide a declaration detailing the nature of the expense and that it is business related. These transactions slips will be retained by my cardholder's department.
8. Monthly Cardholder Statements must be reconciled and returned to Finance within 10 days and approved within the month. I will contact creditcard@lshtm.ac.uk in advance if I require an extension to this timeframe. I also understand that repeated failure to acquit monthly statements in a timely fashion may result in my corporate credit card being cancelled.
9. I will certify that all charges shown are correct and were incurred for official purposes.
10. I will not exceed credit limits. I will request a temporary increase in my limit should this be required for a specific expense.
11. I will not make deposits to the card account.
12. In the event of my termination of employment I will immediately return the corporate credit card and ensure the corporate credit card account is properly reconciled and acquitted.

I acknowledge that I have read and understand the conditions set out above and that I will, at all times, comply with the stipulated requirements.

Signature of Cardholder: _____

Name: _____

Date: _____

Position: _____